

ROMEO AND



JULIET

Introduction to Theatre and Film Costume

Summary

Romeo and Juliet – Short Summary

Author: William Shakespeare

Location: Verona, Italy

Era: Renaissance / 16th Century

Genre: Romantic Tragedy

Summary:

Two powerful families — the Montagues and the Capulets — are sworn enemies in Verona.

But when Romeo Montague and Juliet Capulet fall in love at first sight, their secret romance leads to tragedy.

They marry in secret, but a fight between their families causes Mercutio and Tybalt to die.

Romeo is banished, and Juliet fakes her death to escape an arranged marriage.

Romeo believes she is truly dead and drinks poison.

Juliet wakes, sees him dead, and ends her life too.

Their deaths finally end the hatred between their families.

Theme:

Love vs. Hate, Fate, and Sacrifice.

Character:

The Montague Family

- **Lord Montague** → Head of the Montague family; father of Romeo.
- **Lady Montague** → Romeo's mother; a gentle and loving woman.
- **Romeo Montague** → Only son of Montague; the male protagonist. Falls in love with Juliet Capulet, his family's enemy.
- **Benvolio** → Romeo's cousin and loyal friend; peace-maker, always tries to stop fights.
- **Balthasar** → Romeo's faithful servant; brings him the news of Juliet's "death."
- **Mercutio** → Romeo's witty, fun-loving best friend; loyal but short-tempered; killed by Tybalt.

Neutral / Other Important Characters

- **Friar Laurence** → A kind priest who secretly marries Romeo and Juliet, hoping to end the family feud.
- **Friar John** → Assistant to Friar Laurence; fails to deliver the message to Romeo about Juliet's fake death.
- **Prince Escalus** → The ruler of Verona; tries to keep peace between the two families.
- **Paris** → A nobleman who wishes to marry Juliet; killed by Romeo at the tomb.
- **Servants / Citizens** → Represent the common people of Verona, often caught in the families' violence.

The Capulet Family

- **Lord Capulet** → Head of the Capulet family; father of Juliet. Proud and controlling.
- **Lady Capulet** → Juliet's mother; more concerned with social status than emotions.
- **Juliet Capulet** → Only daughter of Capulet; the female protagonist. Innocent, brave, and deeply in love with Romeo.
- **Tybalt** → Juliet's cousin; aggressive and quick-tempered, always ready to fight the Montagues.
- **Nurse** → Juliet's caretaker and confidante; acts as her mother figure, messenger, and emotional support.
- **Peter** → The Nurse's servant; comic and loyal.
- **Sampson and Gregory** → Capulet servants who start the street fight in Act 1.

6 Characters for Theatre Styling:

Character	Personality / Nature	Costume Style	Color Palette	Fabric	Symbolism
Romeo	Romantic, emotional, poetic, high society impulsive	Fitted doublet with soft cape	Sky blue → Maroon	Velvet, silk	Journey from pure love to tragedy
Juliet (Act 1–2)	Innocent, dreamy, gentle determine high society obdient daughter to brave women	Flowing gown with light drape	Ivory, pastel pink, peach	Chiffon, organza, satin	Purity, innocence, first love
Juliet (Act 3–5)	Passionate, mature, strong-willed	Heavier gown with layered fabric	Crimson, wine, gold, black	Silk, velvet, heavy satin	Courage, sacrifice, emotional depth
Mercutio	Witty, fiery, energetic, cynical	Short doublet, leggings	Red, orange, gold	Brocade, linen blend	Joy, humor, fire of youth
Nurse	Caring, warm, humorous	Layered gown with apron	Beige, brown, rust	Cotton, linen	Motherly love, loyalty, realism
Tybalt	Proud, angry, loyal, attrite	Military-style jacket	Dark red, black, gold	Leather, brocade	Family pride, violence, power

Characters on Stage Act:

Act	Pages	Characters Present	Key Moments
Act 1	1–18	Romeo, Juliet, Mercutio, Nurse, Tybalt	First meeting & family conflict
Act 2	19–31	Romeo, Juliet, Nurse, Mercutio	Balcony scene, secret marriage
Act 3	32–46	Romeo, Juliet, Mercutio, Nurse, Tybalt	Fight scene, deaths, banishment
Act 4	47–55	Juliet, Nurse	Fake death plan, emotional depth
Act 5	56–72	Romeo, Juliet	Final tragedy, double suicide

Characters Changes:

Character	No. of Costume Changes	Scene Context / Time	Style & Mood of Change
1. Romeo Montague	3 Major Changes	Day (Act 1): Street look — light tones, casual noblewear. Night (Act 2): Balcony scene — soft drape, romantic. Night/Tragic (Act 5): Dark tones, heavy fabric, cloak for graveyard scene.	From soft lover to tragic hero. Fabrics move from silk → velvet; color from blue → maroon → black.
2. Juliet (Act 1–2 – Innocent Girl)	2 Changes	Day (Act 1): At home and ball scene — elegant pastel gown. Night (Act 2): Balcony scene — simple soft gown or inner dress.	Light chiffon and organza; romantic tones (ivory, peach, blush). Reflects new love.
3. Juliet (Act 3–5 – Tragic Heroine)	3 Changes	Evening (Act 3): Post-fight scenes — darker dress, emotional mood. Night (Act 4): Potion scene — white “death gown.” Act 5 (Tomb Scene): Same white gown symbolically used in death.	Transition from red passion → pale white. Symbol of purity and sacrifice.
4. Mercutio	2 Changes	Day (Act 1–2): Casual bright noble outfit — playful. Act 3 (Fight Scene): Lighter but flexible outfit for sword fight.	Gold/orange base — linen or brocade for movement. Dies in this costume.
5. Nurse	2 Changes	Day (Act 1–2): Warm tone working gown, apron. Night (Act 3–4): Heavier shawl or darker tone for emotional scenes.	Earthy tones (beige, brown). Always comfortable, practical fabrics. Represents loyalty.
6. Tybalt	1 Major Costume (No Change)	Day (Act 1–3): Street & duel scenes — same bold outfit (red, black).	Heavy brocade or faux leather; military silhouette. His constancy shows his pride & aggression. Dies early, so no transformation.

Seasonal / Time of Day Overview

Scene Type	Lighting & Season Effect	Costume Mood
Morning / Day	Warm yellow lighting – spring/summer feel	Bright, soft, youthful colors (peach, ivory, gold)
Evening / Ball Scene	Warm candlelight, indoor summer setting	Shiny satin, richer tones (silver, coral, red)
Night / Balcony Scene	Cool blue light – calm night	Light chiffon, whites, soft blue hues
Fight / Street Scene	Harsh daylight – summer heat	Practical cuts, flexible fabric, deep tones (red, brown)
Potion / Death Scene	Cold moonlight – autumn/winter tone	Pale shades, heavy velvet, symbolic white and black

Notes:

Romeo: 3 transitions → Love → Loss → Death

Juliet: Split into 2 stages → Innocence → Sacrifice

Mercutio: Short-lived energy → Dies in Act 3

Nurse: Warm consistency → emotionally stable

Tybalt: Static costume → reflects pride and rigidity

Costume: Romeo



Romeo 16th-Century Italian Costume Notes (Age 16)

- Silhouette: Fitted doublet, slim trousers, short cape.
- Sleeves: Slightly puffed or slashed for texture.
- Fabric: Velvet or silk with light gold trim.
- Accessories: Sword belt, boots, feathered hat.

Costume: Juliet



Juliet's 16th-Century Italian Costume Notes (Age 13)

- Silhouette: Fitted bodice, full skirt, high or slightly defined waist.
- Sleeves: Puffed or slashed, softly decorated.
- Fabric & Trims: Silk, brocade, or velvet with light lace details.
- Age Fit: Simpler than adult gowns — lighter fabric, less ornamentation, slightly shorter skirt.

Costume: *Mercutio*



Mercutio's 16th-Century Italian Costume Notes

- Silhouette: Short doublet with flared sleeves and fitted trousers.
- Sleeves: Bold, slightly puffed for drama and movement.
- Fabric: Light brocade or linen blend — flexible for sword fights.
- Accessories: Hat with feather, belt, small dagger.

Costume: *Tybalt*



Tybalt 16th-Century Italian Costume Notes

- Silhouette: Structured doublet with sharp shoulders and fitted trousers.
- Sleeves: Firm and strong, showing control and power.
- Fabric: Brocade or faux leather — heavy and textured.
- Accessories: Sword, gloves, tall boots, belt with metal detailing.

Costume: Nurse



Tybalt 16th-Century Italian Costume Notes

- Silhouette: Structured doublet with sharp shoulders and fitted trousers.
- Sleeves: Firm and strong, showing control and power.
- Fabric: Brocade or faux leather — heavy and textured.
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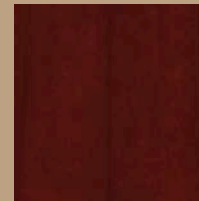
Garment 1 Juliet



Brocket Saree



Gota Patti Lace



Valvate fabric

Act 1, Scene 5 — The Capulet's Feast (Party Scene)

- Romeo sneaks into the Capulet's feast with his friends Mercutio and Benvolio, even though he's from the rival Montague family.
- While looking around, Romeo sees Juliet for the first time — and is completely mesmerized by her beauty.

Garment-2 Juliet

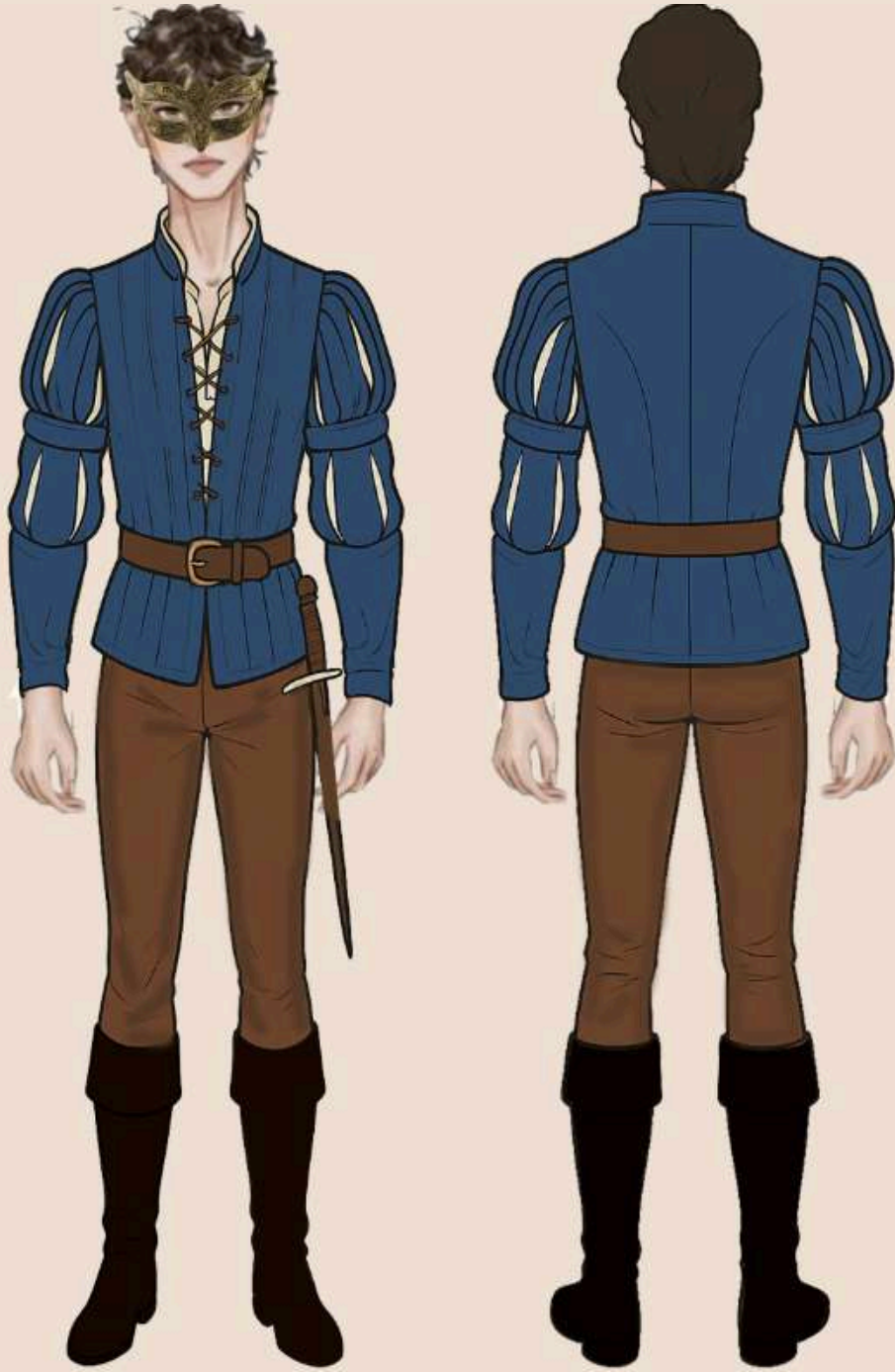


Valvate fabric

Act 3, Scene 4— Marriage seen Romeo and Juliet

- Juliet quietly leaves her house, wrapped in a soft cloak or cape, so no one notices her.
- Her cape hides her identity and symbolizes the secret nature of their love.
- She walks quickly and nervously through the streets of Verona, knowing that what she is about to do will change her life forever.

Garment-3 Romeo



Cotton Fabric



Leather Belt

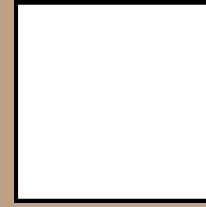


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Garment-4 Nurse



Cotton Fabric



Cotton Fabric

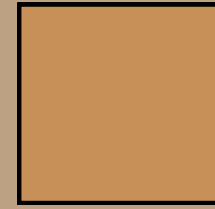
Act 2, Scene 5 — The Nurse's Morning Scene

- Juliet is waiting impatiently for the Nurse to return with news from Romeo.
- She had sent the Nurse to meet Romeo about the plan for their secret marriage.
- The Nurse returns slowly and dramatically, teasing Juliet.
- She purposely delays the news, complaining about her back pain, tired legs, and breathlessness, making Juliet even more anxious.

Garment-5 Marcusto



Cotton Fabric



Cotton Fabric



Leather

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